

a certain number of tools and infrastructure items. Here are a few that have enabled me to keep the bulk-cooking ball rolling.

Resealable freezer bags

The items you'll be preparing will need to be stored in various amounts, so have a range of sizes, from one gallon all the way down to pint and snack-sized.

Masking tape

Certain containers may not have a labeling space. Masking tape is an inexpensive solution.

Permanent marker

Personally, I'm a Sharpie fan from way back, but if you have another favorite brand, go with what you know. These give you an easy way to label and date whatever is in your small containers. The finer the tip, the more information you can fit on a small piece of masking tape.

Tupperware

I recommend having a variety of sizes, like the freezer bags. Depending on whether you are bulk-prepping pizza sauce or coq au vin, you will need a corresponding size of storage container. These are also way easier to wash out and reuse, enabling you to keep bag waste to a minimum.

Extra large airtight containers

This might seem like a repeat of the above item, but when it comes to some of the dry ingredient mixes, making one to five gallons at a time will really make it worth your time. If you are in extreme penny-pinching mode, your empty gallon mayo jugs or extra large pickle jars will store homemade baking mix and dry cream soup base just fine.

Time

You need to reserve a block of time to do the assembly cooking.



Canning jars

Cool home craft projects aside, these things are cheap and allow for quick, safe storage of hostess gifts, homemade jams, and various other things. Stock up. You'll be glad you did.

Metal baking pans with lids

These are best when making something to bring to a party. There are permanently reusable ones if the disposable option bothers you. Personally, I try to keep these to a minimum, but do allow myself a supply for events. They can go immediately into the oven,